which killed the entire Polish state top echelon led by the president, Jaroslaw's brother Lech Kaczyński. Putin and Polish liberals are believed to be somehow involved, according to this conspiracy narrative.

In any event, the accident strengthened Jarosław Kaczyński's belief that the world is (still) a hostile place and that the country's leadership will be taken over by self-proclaimed independent ombudsmen, judicial organs and non-governmental organisations, as well as Putin's Russia. (In his attitude to the latter, he is very different from Orbán.)

According to Sadurski, the ideological motivation of the Law and Justice party is not so much about confronting the remnants of the communist elite in Poland (most of it has been removed through the process of lustration anyway), but mainly about the fear of the traditionally thinking countryside of things liberal, global, multicultural, etc., something argued by Krastev too. In other words, Law and Justice's repeated victory is supposed to be the result of the mindset of rural Poland that has also not benefitted equally from the introduction of a market economy and democracy, despite Poland's favourable macroeconomic position under the previous liberal government. As far as the rural-urban divide goes, this sounds very much like Hungary.

Sadurski admits that before its 2015 defeat, the liberal Civic Platform collapsed, tainted with corruption scandals, having lost contact with voters, especially in rural areas. After the election victory, Law and Justice not only, as explained earlier, problematically interfered in the judiciary and overcame political opponents wherever it could, but also took good care to institute a generous social policy (including an often cited universal child allowance), which many Polish families find essential to make ends meet. All this was possible due to the favourable macroeconomic position of Poland that continued during Law and Justice's term of office, including the rather liberal economic policies of the otherwise conservative Jarosław Kaczyński.

The author sees in all this a typical populist approach, a 'delegative democracy'[159] or a 'plebiscitary autocracy',[160] although he does not deny that Kaczyński enjoys a broad public support, which he is able, like Mr Orbán, to skilfully garner and master. He stresses that the voters of Law and Justice 'have a sense of distance from the cultural values of the liberal elite, and in particular they feel anxiety related to immigration and